

SCOUTING REPORT

Prepared by Tobias Galante — Football Scout | Technical Report

PLAYER DATA

Name: Justin Lerma
Age: 17 years old (May 5, 2008)
Nationality: Ecuador
Position: Attacking Midfielder
Preferred foot: [data not provided]
Current club: Independiente del Valle (agreement in place to join Borussia Dortmund upon turning 18, in 2026)
Background: Professional debut in April 2024, just before turning 16; product of Ecuador's top academy (also home to Caicedo, Hincapié, Pacho, and Kendry Páez); Ecuador U17 international
Report date: 18/08/2025



EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Justin Lerma burst onto the football scene in April 2024, making his professional debut for Independiente del Valle just shy of his 16th birthday. A product of Ecuador's most prestigious academy — the same pipeline that has produced Caicedo, Hincapié, Pacho, and Kendry Páez — he was quickly identified as a generational prospect. Borussia Dortmund conducted an exhaustive scouting process before sealing the deal for the Ecuador U17 international in May 2024, with the plan for him to join the German club upon turning 18 in 2026.

TECHNICAL ANALYSIS

Lerma stands out for his exceptional first touch and body positioning under pressure, allowing him to retain possession comfortably in tight areas. Though less flashy than some of his peers, his technical polish and ease in executing progressive passes reflect a player whose game is built on control rather than pure improvisation.

TACTICAL ANALYSIS

His maturity in reading the game stands out, along with his ability to dictate the tempo of the midfield. This combination of game intelligence and passing range suggests a player capable of organising play from a central attacking role rather than relying solely on individual actions.

PHYSICAL AND MENTAL ASPECTS

Physically imposing for his age, Lerma combines power with poise, showing an advanced physical development that is unusual for a 17-year-old. His early professional debut and the club's structured plan to bring him to Dortmund only once he turns 18 reflect a considered approach to managing his development rather than rushing his transition to European football.

KEY DATA POINTS

- Professional debut in April 2024, just before turning 16.
- Transfer agreement with Borussia Dortmund sealed in May 2024.
- Scheduled move to Dortmund upon turning 18, in 2026.
- Ecuador U17 international.

STRENGTHS AND WEAKNESSES

Strengths

- Exceptional first touch and body positioning under pressure.
- Advanced physical development for his age.
- Comes from an elite academy that has forged multiple global stars.

Areas for Improvement / Limitations

- [data not provided]

PROJECTION AND CONCLUSION

Although his arrival in Europe is still two years away, the stage is already set for his consolidation in elite football. Borussia Dortmund has made its conviction clear in signing a player it considers the next gem of Ecuadorian football, and Lerma's early professional debut combined with his academy pedigree support that level of confidence in his long-term projection.